STUDY AID · MATTHEW 26:17-29 · EPISODE 51 (#54 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

The Blood *of the Covenant*

As it is written of Him

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 26:17-29 in the LSB | 29:10 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Jesus Hid a Message in Plain Sight At the Last Supper. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 26:17-29. On the first day of Unleavened Bread Jesus sends the disciples to a certain man: 'My time is near; I am keeping the Passover at your house.' At the table He says one of them will betray Him: 'He who dipped his hand with Me in the bowl.' Judas asks, 'Surely not I, Rabbi?' Then Jesus takes bread ('this is My body') and a cup ('this is My blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for forgiveness of sins') and says He will not drink of the fruit of the vine until He drinks it new in His Father's kingdom.
- The account is also in Mark 14, Luke 22 and John 13. 'My time' is the appointed time God gives (Ecclesiastes 3:1; Genesis 1:14). Jesus appears to go to His death willingly, at Passover.
- The Passover meal followed an order (seder) built around four cups of wine, with blessings over the wine and bread, the son's question ('Why is this night different?'), the story of the exodus, the lamb, unleavened bread and bitter herbs, and the Hallel psalms (113-118). Jesus explains the bread and cup as His body and the blood of a new covenant.
- The roots run deep: the betrayer who ate my bread (Psalm 41:9); the Servant crushed by Yahweh's will (Isaiah 53:10); 'the blood of the covenant' (Exodus 24:8; Zechariah 9:11); the new covenant (Jeremiah 31:31-33); the Servant given 'as a covenant to the people' (Isaiah 42:6). The four cups may answer the four promises of Exodus 6:6-7; some think Jesus waits to drink the fourth.

> *"As the son of man devoted his whole life to living out the entirety of God's word, so the disciples of the son of man must also do the same."*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Jesus explains these elements as they relate to his body and blood of a new covenant."*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: as the Son of Man devoted His whole life to living out the entirety of God's word, so the disciples of the Son of Man must also do the same. 'The Son of Man is going, just as it is written of Him' (26:24).

Read the meal through its order

Learn the order of the Passover meal (the seder), then ask where Jesus' words fit into it and how He changes their meaning.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 51 of the Matthew study (playlist item 54).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 26:17-29 and turns to Mark 14, Luke 22, John 13, Ecclesiastes 3, Genesis 1, Psalms 41 and 116, Isaiah 42, 49 and 53, Exodus 6 and 24, Zechariah 9 and Jeremiah 31. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 26:17-29
Read in full: the Passover and the Last Supper.

Mark 14:12-31
Mark's account.

Luke 22:7-34
Luke's account.

John 13:21-38
The morsel and Judas's departure.

Ecclesiastes 3:1-8
An appointed time for everything.

Genesis 1:14
Lights for signs and seasons (appointed times).

Psalm 41:9
He who ate my bread lifted his heel.

Isaiah 53:7-10
The Servant crushed, a guilt offering.

Exodus 24:8
Behold the blood of the covenant.

Zechariah 9:9-11
Your king on a donkey; the blood of your covenant.

Jeremiah 31:31-33
The new covenant.

Isaiah 42:6-7
A covenant to the people.

Exodus 6:6-7

Psalm 116:12-15

Four promises of redemption.

The cup of salvation.

Key verses in the LSB

“for this is My blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for forgiveness of sins.”
Matthew 26:28 (LSB)

“I shall lift up the cup of salvation / And call upon the name of Yahweh.”
Psalm 116:13 (LSB)

“A student is not above his teacher; but everyone, after he has been fully trained, will be like his teacher.”
Luke 6:40 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The Passover

The appointed time, the order of the meal, and the betrayer.



MATTHEW 26:17-19; ECCLESIASTES 3:1

My time is near

JESUS · MATTHEW 26:18
“And He said, “Go into the city to a certain man, and say to him, ‘The Teacher says, “My time is near; I am keeping the Passover at your house with My disciples.”’”

THE PREACHER · ECCLESIASTES 3:1
“There is an appointed time for everything. And there is a time for every matter under heaven—”

FROM THE VIDEO How did Jesus know His time had come? We're not told: perhaps divine foreknowledge, perhaps He knew what Judas was planning. He appears to go willingly to die at Passover.

FROM THE VIDEO The video reads Genesis 1 as a chiasm centered on 1:14, where the lights are 'for signs and for seasons'; the word means appointed times (mo'adim). Genesis 1:14

◆ Factbook: Passover



MISHNAH PESACHIM 10

The order of the meal

MATTHEW 26:20-21 (LSB)
“Now when evening came, Jesus was reclining at the table with the twelve disciples. And as they were eating, He said, “Truly I say to you that one of you will betray Me.””

SEDER

FROM THE VIDEO The meal was organized around four cups of wine. Families reclined, a sign of freedom; the father blessed the wine, the son asked why this night is different, and the father retold the exodus, from disgrace to glory (Deuteronomy 26:5-11).

Deuteronomy 26:5-11

BACKGROUND The Mishnah: 'the distributors of charity should not give a poor person less than four cups of wine' and the son asks, 'Why is this night different from all other nights?' (Mishnah Pesachim 10:1, 4).

BACKGROUND The blessings: over wine, 'Who creates fruit of the vine'; over bread, 'Who brings forth bread from the earth' (Mishnah Berakhot 6:1).

◆ Factbook: Passover ◆ Factbook: The Exodus ◆ Factbook: Egypt

MATTHEW 26:21-25; PSALM 41:9

He who dipped his hand

JESUS · MATTHEW 26:23

“And He answered and said, “He who dipped his hand with Me in the bowl is the one who will betray Me.”

DAVID · PSALM 41:9

“Even my close friend in whom I trusted, / Who ate my bread, / Has lifted up his heel against me.”

FROM THE VIDEO The meal probably began with a morsel of bread dipped in a bowl of sauce (haroset); this may be the morsel Judas dipped before leaving (John 13:26-30). John 13:26-30

FROM THE VIDEO 'The Son of Man is going, just as it is written of Him' (26:24): perhaps Isaiah 53 or the anointed one cut off in Daniel 9:26. Matthew 26:24 Daniel 9:26

◆ Factbook: Judas Iscariot ◆ Factbook: David ◆ Factbook: Rabbi



He who dipped his hand with Me in the bowl

James Tissot, The Last Supper: Judas Dipping His Hand in the Dish, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“The disciples are meant to see with their eyes, their physical eyes, but understand through the lens of Tanakh.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Body and blood

Bread, the blood of the covenant, and the Servant.

MATTHEW 26:26

This is My body

MATTHEW 26:26 (LSB)

BREAD

“Now while they were eating, Jesus took some bread, and after a blessing, He broke it. And giving it to the disciples, He said, “Take, eat; this is My body.””

FROM THE VIDEO The father explained the lamb, the bread and the bitter herbs by the exodus. Jesus explains the elements by His body and blood. The bread is unleavened (Exodus 12:15; Deuteronomy 16:3). Exodus 12:15 Deuteronomy 16:3

FROM THE VIDEO The video mentions a custom of hiding a wrapped piece of the broken bread for the children to find, which some scholars link to the Messiah; it says it is unclear whether this happened in Jesus' day.

◆ Factbook: Passover

EXODUS 24:8; ZECHARIAH 9:9-11

The blood of the covenant

MOSES · EXODUS 24:8

“So Moses took the blood and sprinkled it on the people and said, “Behold the blood of the covenant, which Yahweh has cut with you in accordance with all these words.””

ZECHARIAH · ZECHARIAH 9:11

“As for you also, because of the blood of your covenant, / I have set your prisoners free from the waterless pit.”

FROM THE VIDEO Zechariah 9 joins the king on a donkey (9:9) to the blood of the covenant and freed prisoners, as Jesus spoke of the least of these in prison. Zechariah 9:9

FROM THE VIDEO Jeremiah 31:31-33 promises a new covenant written on the heart, and in Isaiah 42:6 and 49:8 the Servant is given 'as a covenant to the people.' Jeremiah 31:33 Isaiah 42:6 Isaiah 49:8

◆ Factbook: New covenant ◆ Factbook: Moses ◆ Factbook: Zechariah (father of John the Baptist)

◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet)

ISAIAH 53:7-10

As it is written of Him

ISAIAH 53:10 (LSB)

THE SERVANT

“But Yahweh was pleased / To crush Him, putting Him to grief; / If You would place His soul as a guilt offering, / He will see His seed, / He will prolong His days, / And the good pleasure of Yahweh will succeed in His hand.”

FROM THE VIDEO The Lord is behind the whole thing, in keeping with Jesus' 'appointed time' and His prayer in 26:39. Jesus becomes the lamb for a new Passover. Matthew 26:39

◆ Factbook: Servant of the Lord ◆ Factbook: Isaiah



This is My blood of the covenant

James Tissot, The Last Supper, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *Jesus explains these elements as they relate to his body and blood of a new covenant.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The fourth cup

Four promises, the Hallel, and the cup Jesus waits to drink.

4

EXODUS 6:6-7

Four promises, four cups

4 EXODUS 6:6-7 (LSB)

REDEMPTION

"Say, therefore, to the sons of Israel, 'I am Yahweh, and I will bring you out from under the hard labors of the Egyptians, and I will deliver you from their slavery. I will also redeem you with an outstretched arm and with great judgments. Then I will take you for My people, and I will be your God; and you shall know that I am Yahweh your God, who brought you out from under the hard labors of the Egyptians."

FROM THE VIDEO Why four cups? Four promises: I will bring you out, deliver you, redeem you, and take you for My people. The fourth is the cup of consummation.

◆ Factbook: The Exodus

PSALM 116:12-15; MATTHEW 26:30

The cup of salvation

THE PSALMIST · PSALM 116:13

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 26:30

“I shall lift up the cup of salvation / And call upon the name of Yahweh.”

“And after singing a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.”

FROM THE VIDEO Psalms 113-118 (the Hallel) were sung through the meal. The video invites us to imagine Jesus singing 'Precious in the sight of Yahweh is the death of His holy ones' (116:15). Psalm 116:15

BACKGROUND The Mishnah: 'they pour him the fourth cup. He completes hallel over it' (Mishnah Pesachim 10:7).

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives



MATTHEW 26:29, 39

Until I drink it new

MATTHEW 26:29 (LSB)

THE FOURTH CUP

“But I say to you, I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on until that day when I drink it new with you in My Father’s kingdom.””

FROM THE VIDEO Some conclude that Jesus did not drink the fourth cup and left the meal unfinished, and that 'let this cup pass from Me' (26:39) refers to that fourth cup, filled by His blood on the cross. Others disagree; the video offers it to chew on. Matthew 26:39

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven ◆ Factbook: Cup

> *“They must live out the totality of God's word in every aspect of life.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 26:17-29

What the video says, then a short background note.

The certain man

VIDEO Host of the Passover, unnamed in Matthew.

BACKGROUND Mark and Luke add a man carrying a water jar and a large upper room (Mark 14:13-15).

Mark 14:13-15

The twelve

VIDEO Each asks, 'Surely not I, Lord?'

BACKGROUND Only Judas calls Him 'Rabbi' (26:25).

Matthew 26:22 ◆ Disciples

Judas Iscariot

VIDEO The one who dipped his hand in the bowl.

BACKGROUND 'You yourself said it' (26:25).

Matthew 26:25 John 13:26-30 ◆ Judas Iscariot

Moses

VIDEO Sprinkled the blood of the covenant at Sinai.

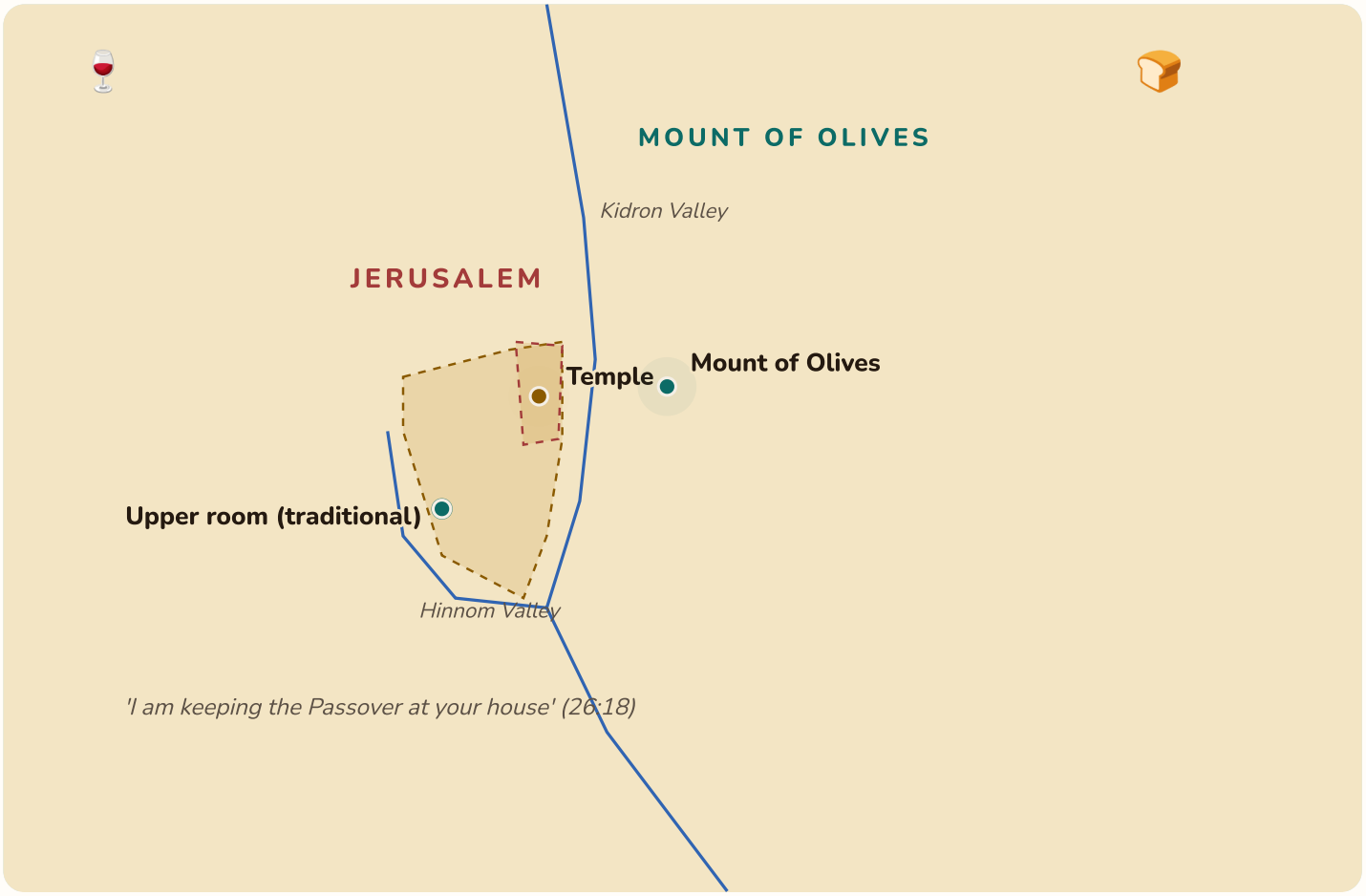
BACKGROUND Exodus 24:3-8 ratifies the covenant after the people answer, 'All the words... we will do.'

Exodus 24:3-8 ◆ Moses

07 · BACKGROUND

The Passover in Jerusalem

The pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century. Traditional sites are marked as traditional.

Upper room (traditional) VIDEO

Where Jesus kept the Passover; traditionally placed on Mount Zion.

Temple BACKGROUND

Passover lambs were slaughtered in its courts on 14 Nisan.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Mount of Olives VIDEO

After singing a hymn, they went out here (26:30).

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives

08

Key terms

Seder

VIDEO

'Order': the set order of the Passover meal.

◆ Factbook: Passover ◆ Factbook: Seder

Four cups

VIDEO

The four cups of wine of the Passover meal (Mishnah Pesachim 10).

◆ Factbook: Cup

Hallel

VIDEO

Psalms 113-118, sung at Passover.

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Hallel

Haroset

VIDEO

A sauce or paste for dipping at the Passover meal.

Tanakh

VIDEO

The Hebrew Bible: Torah, Prophets and Writings.

Halakha

VIDEO

'Walking': living out the Torah in daily life.

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

καιρός

kairos G2540

Time, appointed or decisive time.

Greek · Matt 26:18

πάσχα

pascha G3957

Passover; the Passover lamb or meal.

Greek · Matt 26:18

◆ Factbook: Passover

εὐλογέω

eulogeō G2127

To bless, praise.

Greek · Matt 26:26

διαθήκη

diathēkē G1242

Covenant.

Greek · Matt 26:28

◆ Factbook: New covenant

ἄφεσις

aphesis G859

ὑμνέω

hymneō G5214

Release, forgiveness.
Greek · Matt 26:28

To sing a hymn.
Greek · Matt 26:30

◆ Factbook: Hallel

מוֹעֵד
mo'ed H4150
Appointed time, season, festival.
Hebrew · Gen 1:14

בְּרִית
berit H1285
Covenant.
Hebrew · Exod 24:8

כּוֹס
kos H3563
Cup.
Hebrew · Ps 116:13

◆ Factbook: Cup

יְשׁוּעָה
yeshu'ah H3444
Salvation, deliverance.
Hebrew · Ps 116:13

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Passover and Unleavened Bread
Lambs were slaughtered at the temple on the afternoon of 14 Nisan and eaten that night inside Jerusalem; the seven-day Feast of Unleavened Bread followed (Exodus 12; Deuteronomy 16).

The Mishnah's Passover
Mishnah Pesachim 10, written down about AD 200, describes the four cups, the questions, the explanation of lamb, matza and bitter herbs, and the Hallel. How much was already practiced in Jesus' day is debated.

Reclining
Banquets were eaten reclining on couches, leaning on the left arm; the Mishnah says even the poorest should recline at Passover, 'as free and wealthy people recline' (Mishnah Pesachim 10:1).

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *"For if the type was a deliverance from such bondage, how much more will the truth set free the world, and will He be delivered up for the benefit of our race.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 82, on 26:26-28. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *He gave thanks, and sang an hymn after the giving, that we also may do this selfsame thing.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 82, on 26:30. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Was it a Passover meal?

Matthew, Mark and Luke present it as the Passover; John's timeline places the crucifixion on the day of Preparation (John 19:14). Scholars harmonize this in several ways.

The fourth cup

The video reports the view that Jesus left the fourth cup undrunk; others think Luke's two cups (Luke 22:17, 20) or the Mishnah's order cannot be pressed that far.

'This is My body'

Christian traditions differ on how Christ is present in the Lord's Supper: as real presence, spiritual presence, or memorial.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Judas went to the chief priests (26:14), not the Pharisees.
- The usual name 'Great Hallel' belongs to Psalm 136, not Psalm 118 (Talmud Pesachim 118a).
- The custom of hiding a piece of matza for children to find (the afikoman) is attested only much later; the video rightly says it is unclear for Jesus' day.
- The line 'The world has yet to see what God can do with a man fully consecrated to him' is usually traced to Henry Varley, who said it to D. L. Moody.

11 · BACKGROUND

From the exodus to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 26:17-29 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 BC DEBATED

Four promises of redemption

Exodus 6:6-7

C. 1446 BC DEBATED

The first Passover
Exodus 12:1-28 *Echoed: 26:17-19*

C. 1446 BC DEBATED
The blood of the covenant
Exodus 24:8 *Echoed: 26:28*

C. 600 BC DEBATED
Jeremiah: a new covenant
Jeremiah 31:31-33

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The Last Supper
Matthew 26:17-29 *This episode*

C. AD 200 DEBATED
The Mishnah records the Passover order
Matthew 26:30

C. AD 390
Chrysostom: the type and the truth
Matthew 26:28

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

1 Corinthians 11:23-26
Paul hands on the Lord's Supper
ADDED

1 Corinthians 5:7
Christ our Passover
ADDED

Hebrews 9:15-22
The mediator of a new covenant
ADDED

2 Corinthians 3:3
A letter of Christ, written on hearts
ADDED

Revelation 19:9
The marriage supper of the Lamb
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ What does 'My time is near' show about how Jesus faced His death?

2 ☐ How does knowing the Passover order help you read the Last Supper?

3 ☐ Why do you think each disciple asked, 'Surely not I, Lord?'

4 ☐ What do Exodus 24, Zechariah 9 and Jeremiah 31 add to 'the blood of the covenant'?

5 ☐ Where are you living out God's word, and where only knowing it?

6 ☐ How might your life be 'a letter of Christ' (2 Corinthians 3:3) this week?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: as the Son of Man devoted His whole life to living out the entirety of God's word, so the disciples of the Son of Man must also do the same. The video does not set aside the new covenant, atonement or resurrection; it adds that those trained to be like their rabbi (Luke 6:40) are invited to live out God's word in every aspect of life, like 'a letter of Christ... written not with ink but with the Spirit of the living God' (2 Corinthians 3:3).

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

before you next take the Lord's Supper, read Exodus 12 and Jeremiah 31:31-34, and name one command of Jesus you will put into practice that week.

> *"As the son of man devoted his whole life to living out the entirety of God's word, so the disciples of the son of man must also do the same.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Egypt ◆ Isaiah ◆ The Exodus ◆ Pharisees ◆ Holy Spirit

◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Mount Sinai (Horeb) ◆ Book of Deuteronomy

◆ Book of Psalms ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Chiasm ◆ Disciples ◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Mishnah ◆ New covenant ◆ Prayer ◆ Babylonian Talmud ◆ Valley of Hinnom ◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Forgiveness ◆ Halakha ◆ Messianic banquet ◆ Paul ◆ Priest ◆ Servant of the Lord ◆ Son of Man ◆ Tanakh ◆ Judas Iscariot ◆ Messiah ◆ Rabbi ◆ Passover ◆ Marriage ◆ Cup ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Resurrection ◆ Crucifixion ◆ Day of Preparation ◆ Feast of Unleavened Bread ◆ Hallel ◆ Lord's Supper ◆ Seder

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Mishnah Pesachim 10:1, 4, 7 and Berakhot 6:1: Sefaria, William Davidson Edition (CC BY-NC). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; public domain). Map: drawn for this study.

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/bible-study/bible/matthew-51/